from Space: The ISRO Frame-up, wrote in *Open Magazine* in February 2013:

'*The move to sabotage Isro's cryogenic programme began on 18 January 1991, the date on which Isro signed the agreement, 800-1/50, with Glavkosmos, the Russian space agency. The agreement went against US business interests in two ways.*

'The price quoted by Glavkosmos for the transfer of technology and supply of three cryogenic engines was Rs 235 crore, nearly 400 per cent less than what America's General Dynamics had quoted. The undercutting caused serious concern over sales of American rocket technology elsewhere. Secondly, the price-per-kg–payload fixed for the GSLV to launch satellites into geosynchronous orbit, 36,000 km from Earth, was less than half the price quoted by US vehicles. This, too, meant a market hit for America.'

The ISRO spy case bubble burst in less than two years when the CBI called the IB's bluff, and I was reinstated in ISRO as the director, advanced technology and planning, on 1 June 1996 at the Bangalore headquarters. But the arrest and the subsequent damage the case did to ISRO scientists' morale was so bad that our cryogenic project languished for almost nineteen years. I can say with certainty that if this fabricated case was not to be, India would have launched its first GSLV using an indigenous cryogenic engine at least fifteen years earlier. In fact, I had a special interest to achieve this, as I wanted to see GSLV flying before I retire in 2001.

The dream was shattered when a police jeep from the Vanchiyoor station screeched to a halt in front of my house early in the afternoon of 30 November 1994.